The `take` method returns `nil` if no record is found and no exception will be raised.

You can pass in a numerical argument to the `take` method to return up to that number of results. For example

```
client = Client.take(2)
# => [
  #<Client id: 1, first_name: "Lifo">,
  #<Client id: 220, first_name: "Sara">
]
```

The SQL equivalent of the above is:

```
SELECT * FROM clients LIMIT 2
```

The `take!` method behaves exactly like `take`, except that it will raise `ActiveRecord::RecordNotFound` if no matching record is found.

The retrieved record may vary depending on the database engine.

1.1.3 `first`

The `first` method finds the first record ordered by the primary key. For example:

```
client = Client.first
# => #<Client id: 1, first_name: "Lifo">
```

The SQL equivalent of the above is:

```
SELECT * FROM clients ORDER BY clients.id ASC LIMIT 1
```

The `first` method returns `nil` if no matching record is found and no exception will be raised.

You can pass in a numerical argument to the `first` method to return up to that number of results. For example

```
client = Client.first(3)
# => [
  #<Client id: 1, first_name: "Lifo">,
  #<Client id: 2, first_name: "Fifo">,
  #<Client id: 3, first_name: "Filo">
]
```

The SQL equivalent of the above is:

```
SELECT * FROM clients ORDER BY clients.id ASC LIMIT 3
```

The `first!` method behaves exactly like `first`, except that it will raise `ActiveRecord::RecordNotFound` if no matching record is found.

1.1.4 `last`

The `last` method finds the last record ordered by the primary key. For example:

```
client = Client.last
# => #<Client id: 221, first_name: "Russel">
```

The SQL equivalent of the above is:

```
SELECT * FROM clients ORDER BY clients.id DESC LIMIT 1
```

The `last` method returns `nil` if no matching record is found and no exception will be raised.

You can pass in a numerical argument to the `last` method to return up to that number of results. For example

```
client = Client.last(3)
# => [
  #<Client id: 219, first_name: "James">,
  #<Client id: 220, first_name: "Sara">,
  #<Client id: 221, first_name: "Russel">
]
```

The SQL equivalent of the above is:

```
SELECT * FROM clients ORDER BY clients.id DESC LIMIT 3
```